

Meridian & Associates LLP

Global Professional Services

Diversity, Equity & Inclusion Policy

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Meridian & Associates LLP

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1. Policy Statement and Leadership Commitment

Meridian & Associates LLP is committed to building and sustaining a workforce that reflects the diversity of the communities and clients we serve. We believe that inclusive teams produce superior outcomes, and that equity in opportunity is both a moral imperative and a business advantage. This policy applies to all 68,000+ professionals across every office, service line, and level.

Our Global Managing Partner, the Executive Committee, and the Board of Partners have endorsed this policy and are personally accountable for its implementation. DEI metrics are embedded in leadership performance evaluations and directly influence partner compensation. In FY2025, 15% of partner variable compensation was tied to DEI outcomes.

2. Representation Goals and Current Metrics

2.1 Gender Representation

- Women in total workforce: 46% (current) / 48% (2027 target)
- Women in management (Manager through Senior Manager): 42% (current) / 45% (2027 target)
- Women in senior leadership (Director and above): 34% (current) / 38% (2027 target)
- Women in partnership: 27% (current) / 32% (2028 target)

2.2 Racial and Ethnic Representation (U.S. Operations)

- Underrepresented minorities in total U.S. workforce: 38% (current) / 40% (2027 target)
- Underrepresented minorities in senior roles (Director+): 28% (current, up from 21% in 2022) / 32% (2026 target)
- Black/African American professionals in management+: 12% (current) / 15% (2027 target)
- Hispanic/Latino professionals in management+: 11% (current) / 14% (2027 target)

2.3 Other Dimensions

- LGBTQ+ self-identification rate: 8.2% of workforce (voluntary disclosure)
- Professionals with disabilities: 4.1% self-identification rate
- Veterans: 3.8% of U.S. workforce

3. Talent Acquisition and Pipeline Programs

Meridian invests over \$28 million annually in DEI-related talent programs. Key initiatives include:

- University Partnerships -- Recruiting relationships with 45 HBCUs, 22 Hispanic-Serving Institutions, and 15 tribal colleges. In FY2025, 32% of U.S. campus hires came from these partnerships.
- Meridian Scholars Program -- Full-ride scholarships and guaranteed internships for 200 underrepresented students annually in accounting, technology, and business disciplines.
- Return-to-Work Program -- Structured re-entry pathway for professionals who have taken career breaks of 2+ years. 340 participants since 2021, with 78% conversion to full-time roles.
- Diverse Slate Policy -- All roles at the Manager level and above require a diverse candidate slate (minimum two candidates from underrepresented groups) before an offer can be extended.

- Blind Resume Screening -- Implemented across all entry-level and campus hiring since 2023.

4. Employee Resource Groups (ERGs)

Meridian supports 11 firm-sponsored ERGs, each with an executive sponsor from the Executive Committee and an annual operating budget. Total ERG investment: \$4.2 million in FY2025.

- M-BOLD (Black Organization for Leadership and Development) -- 4,800 members
- Adelante (Hispanic/Latino professionals) -- 3,200 members
- APEX (Asian Pacific professionals) -- 3,600 members
- Pride@Meridian (LGBTQ+ and allies) -- 5,100 members
- Women@Meridian -- 12,400 members
- MeridianVets (military veterans and families) -- 1,900 members
- AccessAbility (professionals with disabilities) -- 1,400 members
- Indigenous Circle -- 600 members
- Working Parents Network -- 8,200 members
- Interfaith Alliance -- 2,100 members
- NextGen (early-career professionals) -- 9,800 members

5. Pay Equity and Transparency

Meridian conducts comprehensive pay equity audits annually, performed by an independent third-party firm. The most recent audit (completed September 2025) found:

- Gender pay gap (adjusted for role, level, tenure, and geography): 0.7% -- within the statistical noise threshold. Remediation adjustments applied where gaps exceeded 1%.
- Racial/ethnic pay gap (adjusted, U.S. operations): 0.9% -- remediation adjustments applied.
- The firm publishes a public Pay Equity Report annually, available on meridianllp.com.
- All compensation bands are disclosed internally by level and geography.

6. Supplier Diversity

In FY2025, Meridian directed \$180 million in procurement spend to certified diverse suppliers, representing 14.2% of addressable procurement. Categories of diverse suppliers include:

- Minority-owned business enterprises (MBEs): \$72M
- Women-owned business enterprises (WBEs): \$54M
- Veteran-owned businesses (VOBs): \$22M
- LGBTQ+-owned businesses: \$14M
- Disability-owned businesses: \$10M
- Small and disadvantaged businesses: \$8M

The firm's target is to reach \$220 million (17% of addressable spend) by FY2027.

7. Inclusive Client Service

We are committed to ensuring our client-facing teams reflect the diversity of the populations our clients serve. Engagement staffing reviews include diversity composition as a mandatory criterion for all proposals and project plans. Our Inclusive Service Delivery training is mandatory for all professionals at the Senior Consultant level and above.

8. Accountability and Governance

- Global DEI Council -- Chaired by the Chief Diversity Officer, reports directly to the Global Managing Partner. Meets monthly.
- Regional DEI Leads -- Dedicated leaders in Americas, EMEA, and APAC with dotted-line reporting to the CDO.
- Annual DEI Scorecard -- Published internally with progress against all targets.
- External Reporting -- Meridian publishes its EEO-1 data (U.S.) and UK Gender Pay Gap Report annually.